

Chapter 5.4

Documentation

- Note 1** The provisions of this Code do not preclude the use of electronic data processing (EDP) and electronic data interchange (EDI) transmission techniques as an alternative to paper documentation. All references to “dangerous goods transport document” in this chapter also include provision of the required information by use of EDP and EDI transmission techniques.
- Note 2** When dangerous goods are offered for transport, similar documents to those required for other categories of goods have to be prepared. The form of these documents, the particulars to be entered on them and the obligations they entail may be fixed by international conventions applying to certain modes of transport and by national legislation.
- Note 3** One of the primary requirements of a transport document for dangerous goods is to convey the fundamental information relative to the hazards of the goods. It is, therefore, necessary to include certain basic information on the document for a consignment of dangerous goods unless otherwise exempted or required in this Code.
- Note 4** In addition to the provisions of this chapter, other elements of information may be required by the competent authority.
- Note 5** In addition to the provisions of this chapter other additional information may be included. However, this information shall not:
- .1 divert attention from the safety information required by this chapter or by the competent authority;
 - .2 contradict the safety information required by this chapter or by the competent authority; or
 - .3 duplicate information already provided.

5.4.1 Dangerous goods transport information

5.4.1.1 General

- 5.4.1.1.1 Except as otherwise provided, the consignor who offers dangerous goods for transport shall give to the carrier the information applicable to those dangerous goods, including any additional information and documentation as specified in this Code. This information may be provided on a dangerous goods transport document or, with the agreement of the carrier, by EDP or EDI techniques.
- 5.4.1.1.2 When the dangerous goods transport information is given to the carrier by EDP or EDI techniques, the consignor shall be able to produce the information without delay as a paper document, with the information in the sequence required by this chapter.

5.4.1.2 Form of the transport document

- 5.4.1.2.1 A dangerous goods transport document may be in any form, provided it contains all of the information required by the provisions of this Code.
- 5.4.1.2.2 If both dangerous and non-dangerous goods are listed in one document, the dangerous goods shall be listed first, or otherwise be emphasized.

5.4.1.2.3 *Continuation page*

A dangerous goods transport document may consist of more than one page, provided pages are consecutively numbered.

- 5.4.1.2.4 The information on a dangerous goods transport document shall be easy to identify, legible and durable.

5.4.1.2.5 Example of a dangerous goods transport document

The form shown in the figure in 5.4.5 is an example of a dangerous goods transport document.*

5.4.1.3 Consignor, consignee and date

The name and address of the consignor and the consignee of the dangerous goods shall be included on the dangerous goods transport document. The date the dangerous goods transport document or an electronic copy of it was prepared or given to the initial carrier shall be included.

5.4.1.4 Information required on the dangerous goods transport document

5.4.1.4.1 Dangerous goods description

The dangerous goods transport document shall contain the following information for each dangerous substance, material or article offered for transport:

- .1 the UN number preceded by the letters "UN";
- .2 the proper shipping name, as determined according to 3.1.2, including the technical name enclosed in parenthesis, as applicable (see 3.1.2.8);
- .3 the primary hazard class or, when assigned, the division of the goods, including, for class 1, the compatibility group letter. The words "Class" or "Division" may be included preceding the primary hazard class or division numbers;
- .4 subsidiary hazard class or division number(s) corresponding to the subsidiary hazard label(s) required to be applied, when assigned, shall be entered following the primary hazard class or division and shall be enclosed in parenthesis. The words "Class" or "Division" may be included preceding the subsidiary hazard class or division numbers;
- .5 where assigned, the packing group for the substance or article, which may be preceded by "PG" (e.g. "PG II").

5.4.1.4.2 Sequence of the dangerous goods description

The five elements of the dangerous goods description specified in 5.4.1.4.1 shall be shown in the order listed above (i.e. .1, .2, .3, .4, and .5) with no information interspersed, except as provided in this Code. Unless permitted or required by this Code, additional information shall be placed after the dangerous goods description.

5.4.1.4.3 Information which supplements the proper shipping name in the dangerous goods description

The proper shipping name (see 3.1.2) in the dangerous goods description shall be supplemented as follows:

- .1 *Technical names for "n.o.s." and other generic descriptions:* proper shipping names that are assigned special provision 274 or 318 in column 6 of the Dangerous Goods List shall be supplemented with their technical or chemical group names as described in 3.1.2.8.
- .2 *Empty uncleaned packagings, bulk containers and tanks:* Empty means of containment (including packagings, IBCs, bulk containers, portable tanks, road tank vehicles and railway tank wagons) which contain the residue of dangerous goods of classes other than class 7 shall be described as such by, for example, placing the words "EMPTY UNCLEANED" or "RESIDUE LAST CONTAINED" before or after the dangerous goods description specified in 5.4.1.4.1.1 to .5.
- .3 *Wastes:* For waste dangerous goods (other than radioactive wastes) which are being transported for disposal, or for processing for disposal, the proper shipping name shall be preceded by the word "WASTE", unless this is already a part of the proper shipping name.
- .4 *Molten substances:* When a substance which is solid in accordance with the definition in 1.2.1 is offered for transport in the molten state, the qualifying word "MOLTEN" shall be added as part of the proper shipping name, unless it is already part of the proper shipping name (see 3.1.2.5).
- .5 *Elevated temperature substances:* If the proper shipping name of a substance which is transported or offered for transport in a liquid state at a temperature equal to or exceeding 100°C, or in a solid state at a temperature equal to or exceeding 240°C, does not convey the elevated temperature condition (for

example, by using the term “MOLTEN” or “ELEVATED TEMPERATURE” as part of the proper shipping name), the word “HOT” shall immediately precede the proper shipping name.

- .6 *Marine pollutants:* Except as provided in 2.10.2.7, if the goods to be transported are marine pollutants, the goods shall be identified as “MARINE POLLUTANT”, and for “not otherwise specified” (N.O.S.) entries the proper shipping name shall be supplemented with the recognized chemical name of the marine pollutant (see 3.1.2.9). The term “MARINE POLLUTANT” may be supplemented with the term “ENVIRONMENTALLY HAZARDOUS”.
- .7 *Flashpoint:* If the liquid dangerous goods to be transported have a primary or subsidiary hazard of class 3 and a flashpoint of 60°C or below (in °C closed-cup (c.c.)), the minimum flashpoint shall be indicated. Because of the presence of impurities, the flashpoint may be lower or higher than the reference temperature indicated in the Dangerous Goods List for the substance.
- .8 *Damaged/defective lithium cells or batteries and lithium cells or batteries for disposal or recycling:* When lithium cells or batteries are offered for transport under special provision 376 or special provision 377, “DAMAGED/DEFECTIVE”, “LITHIUM BATTERIES FOR DISPOSAL” or “LITHIUM BATTERIES FOR RECYCLING” shall be indicated, as appropriate.
- .9 *Stabilized and temperature controlled substances:* Unless already part of the proper shipping name, the word “STABILIZED” shall be added to the proper shipping name if stabilization is used and the words “TEMPERATURE CONTROLLED” shall be added to the proper shipping name if stabilization is by temperature control or a combination of chemical stabilization and temperature control (see 3.1.2.6).

5.4.1.4.4 *Examples of dangerous goods descriptions:*

UN 1092, Acrolein, stabilized, class 6.1 (3), PG I, (–24°C c.c.), MARINE POLLUTANT/ENVIRONMENTALLY HAZARDOUS

UN 1603, ETHYL BROMOACETATE 6.1 (3) II (58°C c.c.)

UN 1603, ETHYL BROMOACETATE, class 6.1, (class 3), PG II, (58°C c.c.)

UN 2761, Organochlorine pesticide, solid, toxic, (Aldrin 19%), class 6.1, PG III, MARINE POLLUTANT

5.4.1.5 *Information required in addition to the dangerous goods description*

In addition to the dangerous goods description, the following information shall be included after the dangerous goods description on the dangerous goods transport document.

5.4.1.5.1 *Total quantity of dangerous goods*

Except for empty uncleaned packagings, the total quantity of dangerous goods covered by the description (by volume or mass as appropriate) of each item of dangerous goods bearing a different proper shipping name, UN number or packing group shall be included. For class 1 dangerous goods, the quantity shall be the net explosive mass. For dangerous goods transported in salvage packagings, an estimate of the quantity of dangerous goods shall be given. The number and kind (e.g. drum, box, etc.) of packages shall also be indicated. UN packaging codes may only be used to supplement the description of the kind of package (e.g. one box (4G)). Abbreviations may be used to specify the unit of measurement for the total quantity.

Note: The number, type and capacity of each inner packaging within the outer packaging of a combination packaging is not required to be indicated.

5.4.1.5.2 *Limited quantities*

- 5.4.1.5.2.1 When dangerous goods are transported according to the exceptions for dangerous goods packed in limited quantities provided for in column 7a of the Dangerous Goods List and chapter 3.4, the words “limited quantity” or “LTD QTY” shall be included.

- 5.4.1.5.2.2 Where a shipment is offered in accordance with 3.4.4.1.2, the following statement shall be included in the transport document: “Transport in accordance with 3.4.4.1.2 of the IMDG Code”.

5.4.1.5.3 *Salvage packagings including large salvage packagings and salvage pressure receptacles*

For dangerous goods transported in salvage packagings in accordance with 4.1.1.18, including large salvage packagings, larger size packagings or large packagings of appropriate type and performance level to be used as a salvage packaging, the words “SALVAGE PACKAGING” shall be included.

For dangerous goods transported in salvage pressure receptacles in accordance with 4.1.1.19, the words “SALVAGE PRESSURE RECEPTACLE” shall be included.

5.4.1.5.4 Substances stabilized by temperature control

If the words "TEMPERATURE CONTROLLED" are part of the proper shipping name (see also 3.1.2.6), the control and emergency temperatures (see 7.3.7.2) shall be indicated in the transport document, as follows:

"Control temperature: ... °C Emergency temperature: ... °C".

5.4.1.5.5 Self-reactive substances, polymerizing substances and organic peroxides

For self-reactive substances, organic peroxides and polymerizing substances which require temperature control during transport, the control and emergency temperatures (see 7.3.7.2) shall be indicated on the dangerous goods transport document, as follows:

"Control temperature: ... °C Emergency temperature: ... °C".

5.4.1.5.5.1 When, for certain self-reactive substances and polymerizing substances of class 4.1 and organic peroxides of class 5.2, the competent authority has permitted the "EXPLOSIVE" subsidiary hazard label (model No. 1) to be dispensed with for the specific package, a statement to this effect shall be included.

5.4.1.5.5.2 When organic peroxides and self-reactive substances are transported under conditions where approval is required (for organic peroxides, see 2.5.3.2.5, 4.1.7.2.2, 4.2.1.13.1 and 4.2.1.13.3; for self-reactive substances, see 2.4.2.3.2.4 and 4.1.7.2.2), a statement to this effect shall be included in the dangerous goods transport document. A copy of the classification approval and conditions of transport for non-listed organic peroxides and self-reactive substances shall be attached to the dangerous goods transport document.

5.4.1.5.5.3 When a sample of an organic peroxide (see 2.5.3.2.5.1) or a self-reactive substance (see 2.4.2.3.2.4.2) is transported, a statement to this effect shall be included in the dangerous goods transport document.

5.4.1.5.6 Infectious substances

The full address of the consignee shall be shown on the document, together with the name of a responsible person and their telephone number.

5.4.1.5.7 Radioactive material

5.4.1.5.7.1 The following information shall be included for each consignment of class 7 material, as applicable, in the order given:

- .1 the name or symbol of each radionuclide or, for mixtures of radionuclides, an appropriate general description or a list of the most restrictive nuclides;
- .2 a description of the physical and chemical form of the material, or a notation that the material is special form radioactive material or low dispersible radioactive material. A generic chemical description is acceptable for chemical form;
- .3 the maximum activity of the radioactive contents during transport expressed in units of becquerels (Bq) with an appropriate SI prefix symbol (see 1.2.2.1). For fissile material, the mass of fissile material (or mass of each fissile nuclide for mixtures when appropriate) in units of grams (g), or appropriate multiples thereof, may be used in place of activity;
- .4 the category of the package, overpack or freight container, as assigned per paragraph 5.1.5.3.4, i.e. I-WHITE, II-YELLOW, III-YELLOW;
- .5 the TI as determined per paragraphs 5.1.5.3.1 and 5.1.5.3.2 (except for category I-WHITE);
- .6 for fissile material:
 - .1 shipped under one exception of 2.7.2.3.5.1 to 2.7.2.3.5.6, reference to that paragraph;
 - .2 shipped under 2.7.2.3.5.3 to 2.7.2.3.5.5, the total mass of fissile nuclides;
 - .3 contained in a package for which one of 6.4.11.2 (a) to (c) or 6.4.11.3 is applied, reference to that paragraph;
 - .4 the criticality safety index, where applicable.
- .7 the identification mark for each competent authority certificate of approval (special form radioactive material, low dispersible radioactive material, fissile material excepted under 2.7.2.3.5.6, special arrangement, package design, or shipment) applicable to the consignment;
- .8 for consignments of more than one package, the information contained in 5.4.1.4.1.1 to .3 and 5.4.1.5.7.1.1 to .7 shall be given for each package. For packages in an overpack, freight container, or conveyance, a detailed statement of the contents of each package within the overpack, freight container, or conveyance and, where appropriate, of each overpack, freight container, or conveyance shall be included. If packages are to be removed from the overpack, freight container, or conveyance at a point of intermediate unloading, appropriate transport documents shall be made available;
- .9 where a consignment is required to be shipped under exclusive use, the statement "EXCLUSIVE USE SHIPMENT"; and

- .10 for LSA-II, LSA-III, SCO-I, SCO-II and SCO-III, the total activity of the consignment as a multiple of A_2 . For radioactive material for which the A_2 value is unlimited, the multiple of A_2 shall be zero.

5.4.1.5.7.2 The transport document shall include a statement regarding actions, if any, that are required to be taken by the carrier. The statement shall be in the languages deemed necessary by the carrier or the authorities concerned, and shall include at least the following points:

- .1 supplementary requirements for loading, stowage, transport, handling and unloading of the package, overpack or freight container, including any special stowage provisions for the safe dissipation of heat (see 7.1.4.5.2), or a statement that no such requirements are necessary;
- .2 restrictions on the mode of transport or conveyance and any necessary routing instructions;
- .3 emergency arrangements appropriate to the consignment.

5.4.1.5.7.3 In all cases of international transport of packages requiring competent authority approval of design or shipment, for which different approval types apply in the different countries concerned by the shipment, the UN number and proper shipping name required in 5.4.1.4.1 shall be in accordance with the certificate of the country of origin of design.

5.4.1.5.7.4 The applicable competent authority certificates need not necessarily accompany the consignment. The consignor shall make them available to the carrier(s) before loading and unloading.

5.4.1.5.8 **Aerosols**

If the capacity of an aerosol is above 1000 mL, this shall be declared in the transport document.

5.4.1.5.9 **Explosives**

The following information shall be included for each consignment of class 1 goods, as applicable:

- .1 Entries have been included for "SUBSTANCES, EXPLOSIVE, N.O.S.", "ARTICLES, EXPLOSIVE, N.O.S.", and "COMPONENTS, EXPLOSIVE TRAIN, N.O.S.". When a specific entry does not exist, the competent authority of the country of origin shall use the entry appropriate to the hazard division and compatibility group. The transport document shall contain the statement: "Transport under this entry approved by the competent authority of ..." followed by the State's distinguishing sign used on vehicles in international road traffic* of the country of the competent authority.
- .2 The transport of explosive substances for which a minimum water or phlegmatizer content is specified in the individual entry is prohibited when containing less water or phlegmatizer than the specified minimum. Such substances shall only be transported with special authorization granted by the competent authority of the country of origin. The transport document shall contain the statement "Transport under this entry approved by the competent authority of ..." followed by the State's distinguishing sign used on vehicles in international road traffic of the country of the competent authority.
- .3 When explosive substances or articles are packaged "as approved by the competent authority", the transport document shall contain the statement "Packaging approved by the competent authority of ..." followed by the State's distinguishing sign used on vehicles in international road traffic of the country of the competent authority.
- .4 There are some hazards which are not indicated by the hazard division and compatibility group of a substance. The shipper shall provide an indication of any such hazards on the dangerous goods documentation.

5.4.1.5.10 **Viscous substances**

When viscous substances are transported in accordance with 2.3.2.5, the following statement shall be included in the transport document: "Transport in accordance with 2.3.2.5 of the IMDG Code."

5.4.1.5.11 **Special provisions for segregation**

5.4.1.5.11.1 For substances, mixtures, solutions or preparations classified under N.O.S. entries not included in the segregation groups listed in 3.1.4.4 but belonging, in the opinion of the consignor, to one of these groups (see 3.1.4.2), the appropriate segregation group name or segregation group code (SGG) listed in 7.2.5.2 preceded by the phrase "IMDG Code segregation group" shall be included in the transport document after the dangerous goods description. For example:

"UN 1760 CORROSIVE LIQUID, N.O.S. (phosphoric acid, acetic acid) 8 III IMDG Code segregation group 1 – Acids"; or

"UN 1760 CORROSIVE LIQUID, N.O.S. (phosphoric acid, acetic acid) 8 III IMDG Code segregation group SGG1.

5.4.1.5.11.2 When substances are loaded together in a cargo transport unit in accordance with 7.2.6.3, the following statement shall be included in the transport document: "Transport in accordance with 7.2.6.3 of the IMDG Code".

5.4.1.5.11.3 When acid and alkali substances of class 8 are transported in the same cargo transport unit, whether in the same packaging or not, in accordance with 7.2.6.5, the following statement shall be included in the transport document: "Transport in accordance with 7.2.6.5 of the IMDG Code".

5.4.1.5.12 *Transport of solid dangerous goods in bulk containers*

For bulk containers other than freight containers, the following statement shall be included on the transport document (see 6.9.4.6):

"Bulk container BK(x) approved by the competent authority of ..."

Note: "(x)" shall be replaced with "1" or "2", as appropriate.

5.4.1.5.13 *Transport of IBCs or portable tanks after the date of expiry of the last periodic test or inspection*

For transport in accordance with 4.1.2.2.2, 6.7.2.19.6.2, 6.7.3.15.6.2 or 6.7.4.14.6.2, a statement to this effect shall be included in the transport document, as follows: "Transport in accordance with 4.1.2.2.2", "Transport in accordance with 6.7.2.19.6.2", "Transport in accordance with 6.7.3.15.6.2" or "Transport in accordance with 6.7.4.14.6.2" as appropriate.

5.4.1.5.14 *Dangerous goods in excepted quantities*

5.4.1.5.14.1 When dangerous goods are transported according to the exceptions for dangerous goods packed in excepted quantities provided for in column 7b of the Dangerous Goods List and chapter 3.5, the words "dangerous goods in excepted quantities" shall be included.

5.4.1.5.15 *Firework classification reference*

When fireworks of UN Nos. 0333, 0334, 0335, 0336 and 0337 are transported, the dangerous goods transport document shall include a classification reference(s) issued by the competent authority.

The classification reference(s) shall consist of the competent authority's state, indicated by the distinguishing sign used on vehicles in international road traffic,* the competent authority identification and a unique serial reference. Examples of such classification references are:

- GB/HSE123456
- D/BAM1234
- USA EX20091234.

5.4.1.5.16 *Classification where new data is available (see 2.0.0.2)*

For transport in accordance with 2.0.0.2, a statement to this effect shall be included in the transport document, as follows "Classified in accordance with 2.0.0.2".

5.4.1.5.17 *Additional entries in the case of the application of special provisions*

Where, in accordance with a special provision in chapter 3.3, additional information is necessary, this additional information shall be included in the dangerous goods transport document.

5.4.1.5.18 *Transport of UN 1361*

For transport of UN 1361, the transport document shall contain the following additional information (see special provision 978 of chapter 3.3):

- .1 Date of production ...
- .2 Date of packing into packagings ...
- .3 Temperature of the material on the day of packing into the packagings ... °C".

5.4.1.5.19 *Actual holding time*

In the case of portable tanks carrying refrigerated liquefied gases the consignor shall enter in the transport document the date at which the actual holding time ends, in the following format:

"END OF HOLDING TIME:..... (DD/MM/YYYY)"